



Plants for pond perimeters

Shady areas close to ponds are perfect for some of the most dramatic plants, the cool moist environment provides ideal growing conditions.

Combine big-leaved beauties such as meadowsweet, leopard plant, rhubarb, and Rodgersia to produce lush tropical-style displays and add splashes of color with bright yellow or orange globeflower and monkey flower, together with striking pink and purple astilbe, turtlehead, and joe pye weed. Alternatively, opt for a cool fernery around your pond, with the bold varying textures of ostrich fern, sensitive fern, and royal ferns. Spring flowering primrose complement ferns beautifully—choose a range of candelabra and drumstick forms for their elegant shapes and compelling colors.



PERENNIAL SMALL

Ajuga reptans

BUGLEWEED This tough, fast-spreading evergreen perennial has rosettes of glossy dark green leaves and, from late spring to early summer, short dark blue flower spikes. Considered invasive in some areas. 'Atropurpurea' (above) has purple leaves.

↑6in (15cm) ↔3ft (1m)

☀ Z3–9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Arisaema triphyllum

JACK-IN-THE-PULPIT An upright perennial with a few large leaves divided into broad lance-shaped leaflets. It has striking, hooded, goblet-shaped green or purple summer blooms formed by fleshy bracts. Bright red berries follow the flowers.

↑20in (50cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ pH ! Z4–9 (N)



PERENNIAL SMALL

Aruncus aethusifolius

GOATSBARD A clump-forming, compact ground-cover perennial with deeply dissected, fernlike green foliage that turns yellow in fall before dropping. In early summer, it produces sprays of tiny creamy white flowers above the leaves.

↑↔16in (40cm)

☀ Z3–9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Astilbe x arendsii

ASTILBE This clump-forming, ferny-leaved perennial produces frothy plumes of white, pink, lilac, or red flowers between early and late summer, depending on the cultivar. The seedheads feature in winter. 'Fanal' has red flowers and dark foliage.

↑18in (45cm) ↔12in (30cm)

☀ Z4–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astilbe chinensis

ASTILBE This perennial forms loose clumps of toothed, deeply cut dark green leaves. In late summer, soft plumes of tiny pinkish white flowers appear on tall stems. *A. chinensis* var. *pumila* is shorter with fluffy raspberry-red spikes.

↑24in (60cm) ↔8in (20cm)

☀ Z4–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Carex elata 'Aurea'

BOWLES' GOLDEN SEDGE An evergreen perennial that forms tufts of long, gently arching, narrow golden-yellow leaves. Thin, grasslike blackish brown flower spikes form in summer. Plant in masses to brighten a shady area.

↑20in (50cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ Z5–9

Astilbe 'Venus'

ASTILBE A leafy perennial with divided leaves and feathery tapering plumes of tiny pale pink flowers on tall stems in midsummer. The dry flower heads provide interest into winter. Best in fertile soil. Needs moisture if exposed to sun or heat.

↑↔3ft (1m)

☀ Z3–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Chelone obliqua

TURTLEHEAD This upright perennial has toothed, lance-shaped green leaves. From late summer to fall, spikes of two-lipped dark pink or purple flowers form. Pinch out stem tips in spring for bushier growth. Add compost for optimum growth.

↑3ft (1m) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ pH Z3–9 (N)